# KARISHNI PURI

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## EDUCATION

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| **P.G.D in Advanced Studies and Research** | Ashoka University | 2023 | 3.59/4 CGPA |
| **BA (Hons.) in Economics** | Ashoka University | 2022 | 3.91/4 CGPA |

*(concentration in International Relations)*

- **Awards**: Summa Cum Laude, Dean's List (6/6 semesters), University Academic Excellence Awardee
- **Teaching & Mentorship:** Mentored 50+ students on the quantitative foundations of machine learning as a Teaching Assistant through tutorials, office hours, and problem-solving sessions.

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**WIOM | Associate (Chief of Staff → Go-to-Market)** **Jan 2024 - Present**

*Series B tech start-up backed by Accel, Prosus & Bertelsmann, pioneering recharge-based home internet to 200K+ households across 10+ Indian cities & towns.*

**Corporate Strategy & Business Planning**

- Developed the investor narrative for Wiom's $40M Series B raise and independently owned data workstreams supporting diligence across 15+ institutional investors; round closed at a $200M valuation.
- Built unit economics, payback, and retention models across 10+ growth scenarios, guiding $5M+ in capital deployment and identifying 15-20% payback improvement opportunities.
- Brought together financial and operating data from 12+ functions for board and investor updates, identifying $1M+ in annual revenue opportunities and key risks requiring leadership attention.

**Organization Design**

- Shaped Wiom's quarterly company priorities and translated them into an Objectives and Key Results (OKR) framework, driving 60% growth in user acquisition in under two months.
- Standardized 140+ existing roles into 5 standard job grades, creating clearer career paths and saving $250K+ in annual hiring costs as the company scaled.

**Customer Acquisition & Go-to-Market**

- Launched Wiom's school-led customer acquisition channel from concept to pilot, developing the GTM model, funnel economics, and rollout plan that reduced acquisition costs in target areas by 15-20%.
- Directed small teams on 50+ customer interviews and field visits to understand adoption barriers; used the findings to improve pricing, product communication, and onboarding, increasing activation by ~10-15%.

**Customer Service & Process Automation**

- Led Wiom's customer-support AI automation initiative, designing a pilot to automate ~60% of customer-support interactions, increasing servicing capacity 2.5× and reducing support cost per minute by 33%.
- Created Wiom's first complete view of customer-support performance, uncovering service failures linked to 20% higher churn and $1M+ in annual revenue at risk.

**ETSY INDIA | Strategic Projects Associate – Seller Growth** **Jul 2023 - Dec 2023**

*Global e-commerce marketplace; member of a lean India team responsible for seller acquisition, activation, retention and growth.*

- Redesigned acquisition and onboarding playbooks for a 90+ member field-sales team, increasing productivity by 22% and enabling ~300–500 additional seller onboardings per month, representing ~$1.5M+ in annual sales.
- Analyzed demand patterns across 15+ product categories, helping prioritize high-potential seller segments representing an estimated $2M+ in annual marketplace sales opportunity.

## LEADERSHIP & EXTRACURRICULARS

- **Captain**, **Ashoka Women's Badminton Team (2022–23):** Led a 10-member team to victories in 2 intercollegiate tournaments and launched Ashoka's first auction-based Badminton League.
- **Department Representative (2021-2022)** for 800+ students; advocated peer priorities with senior faculty and led mentorship initiatives.
- **Cohort Leader, Ashoka University (2020–21):** Mentored 20+ incoming students and organized orientation activities.
- **National Athlete & Adventurer:** Competed in the National Enterprise Class (EC) Dinghy Sailing Championship and HYROX Women's Doubles; certified in PADI Open Water Diving and Basic Alpine Skiing.
- **Performed the lead role** of Portia in Shakespeare's *The Merchant of Venice* at India's National Defence Academy, before an audience of 2,000 military cadets.